

Kaya Van Roost
Curriculum Vitae
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EDUCATION

Postdoctoral fellow

July 2026-present
Drexel University
Urban Health Collaborative at the Drexel Dornsife School of Public Health

PhD Epidemiology

2021–2026
McGill University
Department of Epidemiology, Biostatistics, and Occupational Health
Thesis title: The relationship between child marriage and early fertility in Canada and the United States
Supervisor: Prof. Alissa Koski

Master of Science in Public Health

2019–2021
McGill University
Department of Epidemiology, Biostatistics, and Occupational Health

Bachelor of Science in Biology

2015–2018
The University of British Columbia

OTHER RELEVANT TRAINING

An Overview of Difference-in-Difference and Synthetic Control Methods: Classical and Novel Approaches

2024
Society for Epidemiologic Research

Panel Study on Income Dynamics (PSID) User Training Workshop

2023
University of Michigan Institute for Social Research

Policy Surveillance Institute Legal Epidemiology Workshop

2020
Temple University Center for Public Health Law Research

EMPLOYMENT

Research Assistantships

Research Assistant, McGill Department of Epidemiology, Biostatistics, and Occupational Health

Winter 2026
Supervisor: Dr. Seungmi Yang

- Contributed to a scoping review examining the use of severe maternal morbidity as an exposure in perinatal health research.
- Developed a literature search strategy in collaboration with a research librarian.
- Screened studies for inclusion using Covidence.

Research Assistant, McGill Department of Ethics, Equity, and Policy

Fall 2024

Supervisors: Drs. Jennifer Fishman and Hazal Atay

- Contributed to a project examining approaches to bridging the global gap in abortion access through telehealth.
- Designed the study, conducted data analyses, and presented findings in collaboration with Women on Web, a non-profit organization and online abortion provider.

Research Assistant, McGill Faculty of Law 2022
Supervisors: Drs. Daniel Weinstock and Alissa Koski

- Assisted with preparation of a grant application submitted to the Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council.

Research Assistant, St. Mary's Hospital Research Center 2021–2022
Supervisors: Drs. Jane McCusker and Hannah Schwartz

- Drafted and edited a scientific manuscript for submission to a peer-reviewed academic journal.

Research Assistant, McGill Department of Epidemiology, Biostatistics, and Occupational Health 2021–2022
Supervisor: Dr. Erin Strumpf

- Developed a sampling frame of public and private long-term care homes in Quebec.
- Prepared documentation for research ethics approval.

Research Assistant, McGill Institute for Health and Social Policy 2020–2021
Supervisor: Dr. Alissa Koski

- Developed the structure of a longitudinal database in R containing information on child marriages across the United States.
- Cleaned and analyzed vital statistics data on all marriages occurring since 2000.
- Translated legal memos summarizing statutory rape laws across 25 states into conditional statements for implementation in R.
- Created a longitudinal database of statutory rape laws across 25 states from 2000 onward.
- Drafted a scientific manuscript based on project findings.

Other Employment

Consultant, Data Management, Unchained at Last 2024–Present

- Imported and compiled marriage certificate data for research and advocacy purposes.
- Organized vital statistics data on marriages across all 50 U.S. states using R statistical software.
- Calculated annual estimates of child marriages based on newly available data.
- Communicated analytic approaches and findings with colleagues at Unchained at Last.

PUBLICATIONS

1. Kaya Van Roost, Alissa Koski, Megan Butler, and Miranda Horn. *Changes in Statutory Rape Laws across the United States from 2000 to 2021: A Publicly Available, Longitudinal Database*. 2026. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1111/psrh.70055>.
2. Alissa Koski, Kaya Van Roost, and Fraidy Reiss. "State and Sex-Specific Trends in the Annual Incidence of Child Marriage in the United States since the Year 2000". In: *Child Abuse & Neglect* 147 (2024), p. 106566. ISSN: 01452134. DOI: 10.1016/j.chiabu.2023.106566.
3. Hannah Schwartz, Jane McCusker, Deborah Da Costa, Santokh Singh, Sandhya Baskaran, Eric Belzile, and Kaya Van Roost. "A Pilot Randomized Controlled Trial of a Lay Telephone Coaching and Web-Based Intervention for Postpartum Depression and Anxiety: The MPOWER Study". In: *Internet Interventions* 31 (Mar. 2023), p. 100597. ISSN: 22147829. DOI: 10.1016/j.invent.2022.100597.
4. Kaya Van Roost, Miranda Horn, and Alissa Koski. "Child Marriage or Statutory Rape? A Comparison of Law and Practice Across the United States". In: *Journal of Adolescent Health* 70.3 (Mar. 2022), S72–S77. ISSN: 1054139X. DOI: 10.1016/j.jadohealth.2021.10.023.

PRESENTATIONS

Conference presentations

1. **Oral Presentation.** Population Association of America. (St. Louis, MO, May 2026). Van Roost, K., Koski, A. "Are most child marriages in the United States shotgun weddings? An analysis of the sequencing of childbirth and marriage among minors."
2. **Oral Presentation.** QICSS Emerging Excellence Conference. (Montreal, QC, April 2026). Van Roost, K., Koski, A. "The relationship between child marriage and teen childbearing in Canada."
3. **Oral Presentation.** School of Population and Global Health Research Day. (Montreal, QC, February 2026). Van Roost, K., Koski, A. "Child marriage and teenage childbearing in Canada."

4. **Poster Presentation.** Population Association of America. (Washington, DC, April 2025). Van Roost, K., Koski, A. “The Relationship Between Pregnancy, Childbirth, and Child Marriage in the United States.” **Awarded poster winner.**
5. **Oral Presentation.** School of Population and Global Health Research Day. (Montreal, QC, February 2025). Van Roost, K., Harper, S., Austin, N. “Is TRAP law enforcement associated with an excess change in abortion providers?” **Awarded second-place oral presentation.**
6. **Poster Presentation.** School of Population and Global Health Research Day. (Montreal, QC, February 2025). Van Roost, K., Atay, H., Fishman, J. “Did abortion decriminalization impact demand for medical abortion via telemedicine in South Korea?”
7. **Poster Presentation.** Department of Ethics, Equity, and Policy Internship Poster Session. (Montreal, QC, December 2024). Van Roost, K., Atay, H., Fishman, J. “Did abortion decriminalization impact demand for medical abortion via telemedicine in South Korea?”
8. **Seminar Speaker.** Center for Population Dynamics Seminar Series. (Montreal, QC, November 2024). “Constructing a Longitudinal Policy Database: An Applied Example on Statutory Rape Laws.”
9. **Oral Presentation.** Panel Study of Income Dynamics User Conference. (Ann Arbor, MI, September 2024). Van Roost, K., Koski, A. “The relationship between pregnancy, childbirth, and child marriage in the US.”
10. **Oral Presentation.** Society for Epidemiologic Research. (Austin, TX, June 2024). Van Roost, K., Austin, N., Koski, A. “The Impact of Targeted Restriction on Abortion Provider Laws on Rates of Childbirth Among Minors in the US.”
11. **Oral Presentation.** McGill Epidemiology, Biostatistics, and Occupational Health Research Day. (Montreal, QC, March 2024). Van Roost, K., Austin, N., Koski, A. “The Impact of Targeted Restriction on Abortion Provider Laws on Rates of Childbirth Among Minors in the US.” **Awarded first-place oral presentation.**
12. **Panelist.** Legal Epidemiology in Law Enforcement and Public Health Conference (Temple University, March 2021). Van Roost, K., Horn, M., Koski, A. “Child marriage or statutory rape? A comparison of law and practice across the United States since the year 2000.”

Invited Lectures, Talks, and Presentations

An Introduction to Causal Diagrams (Interactive Training Workshop)

Fall 2023, Fall 2024

Consortium on Analytics for Data-Driven Decision Making (CAnD3). Delivered an interactive training workshop introducing principles of causal diagrams, including their application to epidemiologic study design and causal inference.

Media Appearances

QUB radio, L'Intégrale avec Benoit Dutrizac.

February 20, 2023

Le mariage à 16 ans au Canada: Ce n'est pas de cas de “puppy love”
(Translation: Marriage at age 16 in Canada: It's not ‘puppy love’)

FUNDING

External Grants and Awards

Funded

Type: Emerging Scholars Grant

Funding Agency: Canadian Research Data Centre Network

Total amount: 1,200 CAD

Date: Fall 2024

Type: Entrance Scholarship

Funding Agency: Quebec Inter-university Center for Social Statistics

Total amount: 2,000 CAD

Date: Fall 2024

Title: Déterminants et conséquences du mariage des enfants en Amérique du Nord

Funding Agency: Doctoral Student Award from Fonds de recherche du Québec – Santé

Role Status: Awardee

Percentage of Attributed Effort: 100

Total amount: 83,333 CAD

Coverage Period: 2023–2027 (declined 2026–2027)

Title: Determinants and consequences of child marriage in Canada and the United States

Funding Agency: Canadian Institutes of Health Research (CIHR)

Role Status: Co-applicant

Percentage of Attributed Effort: 15

Total amount: 160,000 CAD

Coverage Period: 2022–2025

Internal Grants and Awards

Funded

Type: Graduate Student Travel Award

Funding Agency: McGill Department for Ethics, Equity and Policy

Total amount: 1,500 CAD

Date: April 2026

Type: Poster award

Funding Agency: McGill Department for Ethics, Equity and Policy

Total amount: Non-monetary

Date: April 2025

Type: Travel Award

Funding Agency: McGill Center for Population Dynamics

Total amount: 500 CAD

Date: April 2025

Type: 2nd Place Oral Presentation

Funding Agency: McGill School of Population and Global Health Research Day

Total amount: 50 CAD

Date: February 2025

Type: 1st Place Oral Presentation

Funding Agency: McGill School of Population and Global Health Research Day

Total amount: 100 CAD

Date: February 2024

Type: Graduate Award Program

Funding Agency: McGill Department for Ethics, Equity and Policy

Total amount: 2,000 CAD

Date: February 2022

TEACHING AND ADVISING

Teaching Assistantships

Course Title: Undergraduate Medical - Epidemiology small groups

Institution: McGill University

Term and Year Taught: Fall 2024

Number of Students: 15

Course Title: MSc level - Critical Appraisal in Epidemiology

Institution: McGill University

Term and Year Taught: Winter 2024

Number of Students: 30

Course Title: MSc level - Introduction to Epidemiology

Institution: McGill University

Term and Year Taught: Winter 2024

Number of Students: 20

Tutoring

Course Titles: MSc level -Inferential Statistics, Intermediate Epidemiology, Data Analysis in the Health Sciences
Institution: McGill University School of Population and Global Health
Year Taught: Winter 2021–Fall 2022
Number of Students: 5

SERVICE & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Student Representative, School of Population and Global Health Director Search Committee Winter 2025

- Participated in committee meetings to identify and select candidates for the Director of the School of Population and Global Health.
- Represented student perspectives and interests in discussions regarding future leadership and strategic direction of the School.

President, Epidemiology, Biostatistics, and Occupational Health Student Society 2023–2024

- Represented student interests at departmental meetings and Education Standing Committee meetings.
- Served as a liaison between students and faculty to facilitate communication and address student priorities.
- Organized departmental events, including the welcome back event, holiday party, spring banquet, and research day, including securing funding to support these initiatives.
- Organized and chaired monthly meetings of the Epidemiology, Biostatistics, and Occupational Health Student Society and coordinated activities among council members.
- Advocated for student priorities, including initiatives related to student funding and access to departmental student spaces.

Organizer, Social Epidemiology Journal Club 2021–2025

- Organized monthly discussions of recently published social epidemiology research.
- Facilitated discussions with faculty and students on study design, methodology, interpretation, and implications of emerging research.
- Managed communications, including mailing lists and departmental advertisements.

Comprehensive Exam Representative, Epidemiology, Biostatistics, and Occupational Health Student Society 2022–2023

- Served as a liaison between students and the comprehensive examination committee.
- Led five comprehensive exam preparation workshops to support student preparation.
- Advocated for increased transparency in grading procedures and improved student access to examination results.

Scientific Journal Referee

- *Epidemiology* (n=1)
- *Journal of Adolescent Health* (n=1)
- *BMC Health Services Research* (n=1)
- *Internet Interventions* (n=1)
- *Journal of Urban Health* (n=1)